

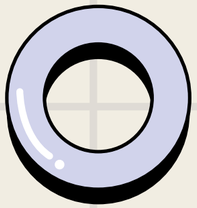
PRESENTATION PREP



Summer Mentorship Program 2026

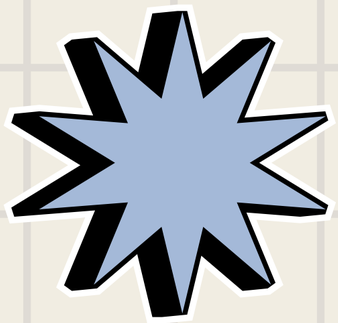
MINI ACTIVITY: ONE TRUTH, ONE LIE, AND ONE RESEARCH

- Get up & talk to someone you don't usually sit next to
- Each person shares **one true fact about yourself, one lie about you**, & **one true fact about your research**
    - **Ex:** I love chemistry, I cultured cancer cells this summer, I passed out at the smell of a chemical broth
- Your partner guesses which statement was the lie
- **Goal**: Get your voice warmed up and get people talking about their projects out loud before the real thing



GENERAL TIPS:

1. Know your stuff



- **True Clarity Comes from depth**
  - Anxiety often stems from the fear of the **unknown**. To present clearly, you must **understand** your research at a comfortable level for you

- **Anticipate the "Difficult" questions**
  - You know your project better than anyone!

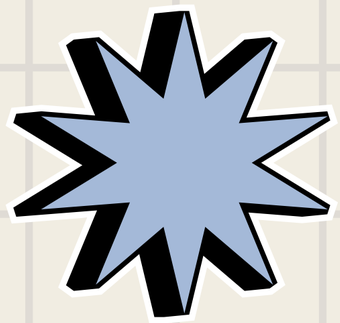
- **Know your data's limitations as well as its strengths, and be able to point to each**

Turn and Talk:

What's one part of your project you feel least confident explaining?

- Talk it through with the people next to you!

2. Practice!



- **Self-recording of you giving your project presentation**
  - Notice **where** you mess up on → do more reading on that!
- **Practice “project pitch”**
- **Rehearse like it’s the real thing**
  - w/ parents, friends, etc.
  - practice eye contact, pacing, flow, etc.

3. Reframe Your Thinking

- **“I am anxious” vs. "I am Excited"**
  - **Fun fact:** Anxiety and Excitement feel identical to the body

- **Turn “a presentation” into “an opportunity to share”**

Turn and Talk:

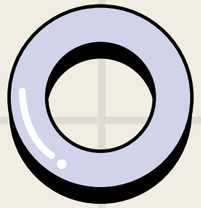
Share one nerves-management strategy that you use with the people around you

TECHNICAL TIPS FOR POSTER PRESENTATIONS:

1. Your research is a story, your audience is the reader



- **Where to begin? CONTEXT!**
  - Like any story, audience needs to know the **WHY**.
  - Audience also needs to know the **WHAT** (define unknown terms verbally and briefly, depending on audience)



- **Journey**: What did you want to learn more about? How did you do that? Map out these questions as you go from **Introduction** to **Methods**
- Close with a **conclusion** and "**cliffhanger**": What did you find out, by the end of the story? What do we still not know (limitations)?

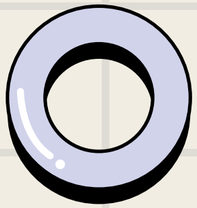
Turn and Talk:

Try to tell the people around you your “research story” in 30 seconds.

Include the WHY, the journey, and the “cliffhanger” ending!

2. How to Q&A

- **View**: Use questions given to you as an opportunity to share more about your work!
- **Prepare in advance**: What are some gaps in your own research? What are the next steps?
- **Pivot if you don’t know**: If you don’t know the answer to a question, still answer! Something like: “I don't have that data, but here's how I'd approach finding it...”



FUN ACTIVITY: TEAM PITCHES

- **We will split you into groups, and two groups will go against each other and debate a topic:**
  - ex: Is cereal technically a soup?

- **Each team has 1 minute to speak, and multiple people can speak in the same round (tag-team pitch)**
- **Between rounds, teams get 1 minute to prep their argument**

- **Goal**: Try to convince a mentor that your side is correct!